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EXCLUSIVE U.S.

The Accomplice Who Was Going to Testify Against Jeffrey Epstein—Then Went Dark

French model scout Jean-Luc Brunel was negotiating to provide prosecutors with evidence against the sex offender in 2016—three years before he was finally arrested—but ultimately backed out



Jeffrey Epstein and Jean-Luc Brunel in an undated photo. JUSTICE DEPARTMENT



Jeffrey Epstein and Jean-Luc Brunel in an undated photo. JUSTICE DEPARTMENT

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Jean-Luc Brunel was ready to turn on the man who had been his patron and partner. The French modeling scout was prepared to tell prosecutors what he knew about Jeffrey Epstein’s sex trafficking.

Brunel was secretly negotiating in 2016 with lawyers representing Epstein’s victims, according to newly released Justice Department files. Brunel’s lawyer told them his client recruited girls for Epstein and had incriminating photographs. They discussed a date for Brunel to walk into the U.S. Attorney’s office in New York—in exchange for immunity.

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